Failure (force the parser to actually fail) — Hints

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Only 2 hints — work through them in order, and don't jump ahead until you've genuinely tried. Each hint builds toward the full solution.

- Hint 1 — Forcing a real failure: "check after"
- Hint 2 — The plan, and almost the whole thing

Hint 1 — Forcing a real failure: "check after"

The error is `OutputParserException` (from `langchain_core.exceptions`) — catch it by name, never a bare `except`, so a network error or a bad key still fails loudly.

Then fix the cause, not just the symptom: tell the model the shape. `parser.get_format_instructions()` returns that text, and `.partial(format_instructions=...)` fills a `{format_instructions}` slot once, so callers still pass only `{thing}` (the Prompt templates topic).

`parser.parse("some text")` checks any text with no API call — a free way to test the failure again.

Hint 2 — The plan, and almost the whole thing

```
BROKEN_TEMPLATE = "Rate {thing} from 1 to 10."
FIXED_TEMPLATE  = "Rate {thing} from 1 to 10.\n{format_instructions}"

function build_rating_chain(template) -> Runnable:
    prompt from the template
    if the template has {format_instructions}: fill it with .partial()
    return prompt | model | parser

function get_rating(chain, thing) -> Rating | None:
    try: return chain.invoke(...)
    except OutputParserException: return None
```

Run the broken chain, the fixed chain, and `parser.parse("I'd say eight")`, then compare against the Solution.

Full solution: Show me the solution